

Sourdough bread – Method

Basic method - easy sandwich-loaf shape

- Scoop the starter into a mixing bowl, keeping a tiny bit behind.
- Refresh your starter for the next bake:
 - in the "dirty" starter jar, add **50 g whole-wheat flour¹** and **50 g water**.
 - Mix well, put the lid on, and leave it to ferment on the counter together with the bread.
- Continue with the bread and add the water, flour, and salt. Mix with a spoon or by hand.
- Transfer the dough to a loaf pan. Use a non-stick pan (e.g. silicone) or grease the pan with an oil that tolerates high temperatures (e.g. rice oil). Cover to prevent drying out.



Leave to ferment on the counter for 10-14 hours.

- Put your starter jar in the fridge, ready for the next bake.
- Put the bread in a preheated oven. Preferably cover it with a second loaf pan: this creates a steam effect.
- **Last 10 minutes of baking:** remove the lid. For silicone loaf pans: remove the bread from the pan and continue baking without the pan.
- Take the bread out of the oven, remove it from the pan immediately, and leave it to cool upside down.

Optional - a more artisanal shape

- Leave the dough to ferment in the mixing bowl, covered to prevent drying out.
- Shape the dough before placing it in the loaf pan. This tightens the gluten network. Watch a few videos to learn how to do this.
- Score the bread with a sharp knife, 1-2 cm deep, at a shallow angle. One long line, or your own pattern. This is where the bread can open up during oven spring. This happens less with the basic method above, because there the dough goes into the oven fully risen, while here it deflates a little during shaping.
- Otherwise: identical to the basic method above.

Tips

- Fermentation time depends strongly on temperature. To speed up the process: start with warm water (40 °C) and/or put the dough in a warm place. It is possible to have a loaf ready in 4-6 hours.
- To pause fermentation and postpone baking: put the dough in the fridge (covered). This also gives a more complex/sour flavour.
- Quantity matters: a large loaf needs to ferment longer than a small loaf with the same amount of starter.
- The longer or slower the fermentation, the sourer the bread.
- The younger your starter, the fresher it tastes (lactic acids). The longer it stays in the fridge without being refreshed, the more acetic acid it develops. But you can always keep baking bread with it.

Sourdough bread – Recipes

Whole-wheat wheat (or spelt)	Small	Medium	XL		% of flour
Starter	100 g	100 g	100 g		
Whole-wheat flour	450 g	575 g	950 g	+50 g in starter	100 %
Water (maximum)	350 g	450 g	750 g	+50 g in starter	80 %
Salt	8 g	10 g	16 g		1.8 %
Baking time at 220 °C	45 min.	45 min.	50 min.		

Mixed wheat (or spelt)	Small	Medium	XL		% of flour
Starter	100 g	100 g	100 g		
Whole-wheat flour	200 g	260 g	450 g	+50 g in starter	50 %
White wheat flour (T65)	250 g	310 g	500 g		50 %
Water (maximum)	325 g	420 g	700 g	+50 g in starter	75 %
Salt	8 g	10 g	16 g		1.8 %
Baking time at 220 °C	45 min.	45 min.	50 min.		
<i>Instead of a mix, you can also use partly refined flour, e.g. T85 flour.</i>					

White wheat (or spelt)	Small	Medium	XL		% of flour
Starter	100 g	100 g	100 g		
White wheat flour (T65)	450 g	575 g	950 g	+50 g in starter	100 %
Water (maximum)	300 g	390 g	650 g	+50 g in starter	70 %
Salt	8 g	10 g	16 g		1.8 %
Baking time at 220 °C	45 min.	45 min.	50 min.		

Rye	Small	Medium	XL		% of flour
Starter (g)	100 g	100 g	100 g		
Whole-rye flour	400 g	510 g	850 g	+50 g in starter	100 %
Water (maximum)	400 g	510 g	850 g	+50 g in starter	100 %
Salt	7 g	9 g	14 g		1.8 %
Baking time at 220 °C	50 min.	50 min.	55 min.		

Olive bread	Small	Medium	XL	% of flour
Wheat bread	see above			
Less salt*	-2 g	- 2 g	-4 g	-0.4 %
Drained sliced olives	150 g	190 g	300 g	26 %
<i>* Olives already contain a lot of salt.</i>				

Almond-fruit bread	Small	Medium	XL	% of flour
Wheat bread	see above			
Raisins	40 g	50 g	80 g	8 %
Dried apricot pieces	40 g	50 g	80 g	8 %
Almonds*	80 g	100 g	160 g	16 %
Orange blossom water (optional)	3/4 tbsp	1 tbsp	1 ½ tbsp	
Baking time** at 205 °C	50 min.	50 min.	55 min.	
<i>* Preferably dry-roasted almonds. You can buy them, or roast them yourself in the oven or in a pan (without fat).</i>				
<i>** Adjusted temperature and baking time to prevent the fruit from burning.</i>				

Rye raisin-walnut bread	Small	Medium	XL	% of flour
Rye bread	see above			
Currants	80 g	100 g	160 g	16 %
Walnuts	80 g	100 g	160 g	16 %
Baking time** at 205 °C	55 min.	55 min.	60 min.	
<i>** Adjusted temperature and baking time to prevent the fruit from burning.</i>				

Seed bread	Small	Medium	XL	% of flour
Rye bread	see above			
Flaxseed	50 g	60 g	100 g	6 %
Sunflower seeds	50 g	60 g	100 g	10 %
Pumpkin seeds	50 g	60 g	100 g	10 %
<i>* Tip: first roast the flaxseed and seeds in the oven or in a pan (without fat).</i>				

Other ideas/additions

- In autumn and winter: dried fig pieces and chopped sage leaves
- An Eastern European touch: caraway seeds, optionally combined with fennel seed
- Whole grains such as buckwheat, oat groats, spelt, rye, or barley. In that case, also add some extra water (about 80% of the weight of the grains)².
- Some poppy seeds on top of the dough. This also helps prevent crusting during fermentation.

1. Always use whole-grain flour for the starter; white flour contains almost no microorganisms. Rye flour also works, giving you a different type of starter (more acetic).

2. Dried fruit also absorbs water, but much less: typically 20% of its weight. Flaxseed or chia seed also absorbs water and makes your bread drier. These effects are ignored in the (very wet) recipes above.